

Tips & Tricks

SECRETS THAT KEEP YOU AHEAD IN THE RACE

TIPS

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WINDOWS XP



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No matter how much we deconstruct it, there's so much to Windows that we haven't let discovered. This month: random tips to (what else) enhance your experience, and how you can use Registry hacks without actually using the Registry.



Pretty Folder Pictures

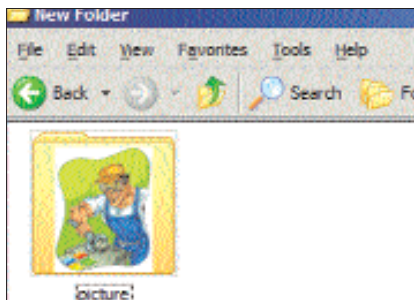
We all know that images within a folder show up in the thumbnail view of the folder, but what if you want only one of these images to show up? Just rename this image to folder.jpg (folder.gif works too)! Even better, if you do this for your music collection, Windows Media Player will load this

image as album cover art if you've disabled visualisations.



No More Admin Shares

By default, Windows shares your all drives (C: shared as C\$, D: as D\$ and so on) so that you can access them over the network using your administrator password. However, if you're the paranoid kind or need to share your admin password with your colleagues from time to time, you might want to turn this off. You can do this using the Sharing tab under the drive's properties, but the shares are enabled again after you restart. For the permanent solutions, open the Registry Editor (Start > Run > "regedit" > [Enter]) and navigate to HKEY_



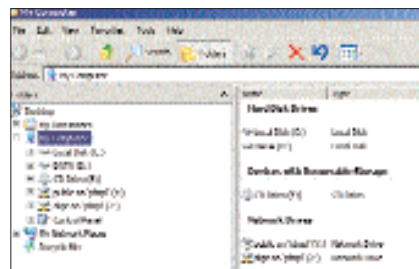
Give folders a thumbnail

LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services\LanManServer\Parameters. Right-click in the right-hand pane and select New > DWORD value. Call this DWORD "AutoShareWks", and assign it a value of 0 (which it should be by default). Restart your PC for the change to take effect.



Remove The Shared Documents

Hate the "Shared Documents" icon at the top of your My Computer window? Instead of trying to figure out why this bizarre "feature" was needed, here's how you can be rid of it: open the Registry Editor (Start > Run > "regedit" > [Enter]), go to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\My Computer\NameSpace\DelegateFolders, and delete the sub-key (it looks like a folder) called {59031a47-3f72-44a7-89c5-5595fe6b30ee}. You should see the effect immediately.

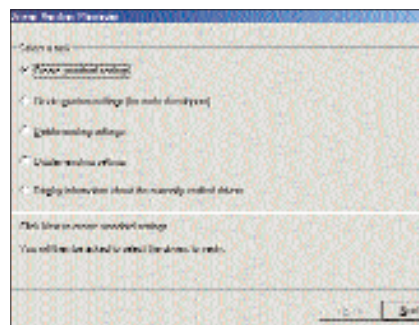


My Computer, as it should be



Track Down Naughty Drivers

While you rarely see a BSOD with Windows XP, the few times they do crop up are usually due to misbehaving drivers. To see which of these (if any) is causing your problems, use XP's unsung Driver Verifier (Start > Run > "verifier" > [Enter]). In the first screen, select Create Standard Settings and move ahead to select which drivers to verify. Once



The Driver Verifier identifies broken drivers

you've done that, you'll need to reboot to let the Verifier do its job. If a driver is indeed your problem, then you'll get a blue screen during the booting process which will tell you which driver it is. If your PC boots fine, then your problems lie elsewhere.

To reset the verifier, do Start > Run > verifier /reset > [Enter].



Share Folders With Ease

If you've got a large number of folders you want to share on the network, navigating to each one of them and going